

The rural sector accounts for the largest share of occupied housing units, increasing from 4,092,252 to 4,773,336, and continues to dominate the national total. The urban sector also records a notable increase, rising from 891,103 to 1,028,363, reflecting ongoing urban expansion. In contrast, the estate sector shows only a marginal increase, from 224,385 to 228,842, suggesting relatively slow growth in housing within estate areas compared to the other sectors.

Table 11.2 : Number of Occupied Housing Units & Permanently Closed/Vacant Housing Units by District, 2012 and 2024

District	2012		2024	
	Occupied housing units	permanently closed/vacant	Occupied housing units	permanently closed/vacant
Sri Lanka	5,207,740	686,507	6,030,541	898,101
Colombo	562,550	78,052	654,051	113,837
Gampaha	598,674	65,355	683,025	102,557
Kalutara	302,371	35,199	349,430	45,678
Kandy	342,911	41,803	389,826	53,787
Matale	128,090	16,001	148,184	21,617
Nuwara Eliya	178,440	21,627	192,915	28,387
Galle	271,236	42,176	305,379	43,462
Matara	205,153	29,209	230,034	33,039
Hambantota	155,716	24,223	187,558	29,971
Jaffna	136,969	21,364	156,797	34,718
Mannar	23,338	4,352	32,005	7,477
Vavuniya	41,436	6,244	47,825	11,141
Mullaitivu	24,684	3,901	34,348	7,128
Kilinochchi	28,208	3,387	36,484	6,533
Batticaloa	133,436	20,866	167,150	23,788
Ampara	163,243	23,530	202,861	27,002
Trincomalee	95,679	16,957	119,351	17,885
Kurunegala	440,517	51,817	506,909	67,480
Puttalam	201,364	31,195	231,494	41,358
Anuradhapura	229,032	25,307	271,408	37,842
Polonnaruwa	110,326	13,556	126,482	17,291
Badulla	211,178	24,766	239,417	30,525
Moneragala	119,503	18,765	150,728	22,206
Ratnapura	284,282	41,887	324,853	42,866
Kegalle	219,404	24,971	242,027	30,526

According to the Census of Population and Housing – 2024, a total of 6,030,541 occupied housing units were reported in Sri Lanka. The highest number of occupied housing units was reported in the Gampaha District (683,025), while the lowest was observed in the Mannar District (32,005). Furthermore, as indicated in Table 11.2, the Colombo District reported the highest number of vacant housing units, whereas the lowest number of vacant units was reported in the Kilinochchi District.